

Ski School, Day 2 @ Bogong Rover Chalet

Purpose

To coach, assess and verify skills of Winter Party Participants.

Coach the basic skiing skills for OAS Alpine XC Skiing and Trained Participant – Cross Country Skiing.

Assess the ability of Participants to assist with Tour Planning during the Winter Party.

Verify Skills for OAS or adult qualification – This may be revisited during the week as skills improve with practice and coaching.

Background

The ski into the Chalet can be challenging – often it is participants first time on skis and their first time carrying a pack on skis. The ski school is an opportunity to build on the skills developed on the ski in and previous skiing activities while not hampered by a heavy pack.

All party members will be encouraged to obtain formal ski/snow qualifications. It is therefore expected that, over time, there will be a strong presence of participants having Trained Participant Cross Country Patrolled or Trained Participant Show Shoeing Day Tour qualification or Trained Participant Bushwalking Extremely Difficult Tracked & Untracked Environments or higher qualification (Guide).

Activity Summary

While participating in a guided ski tour, participants learn, demonstrate and practice a variety of skills. The activity should start after breakfast, with preparing what to take and completing the trip plans. Ideally it should include a touring lunch, or at least morning tea on the snow to get participants familiar with a typical tour.

All winter party participants should participate in the activities, experienced skiers should assist with leadership, demonstration and coaching.

The activity will include demonstrations and coaching along the journey using the natural terrain.

Timing

Weather permitting, the activity should commence after morning duties and ideal conclude after lunch. Planning for the activity should commence the previous evening (between meal courses) and include a briefing and equipment check prior to departing the chalet.

Location and route

The suggested outline is to commence at the Chalet, head east along the Langfords West Aquaduct to Wallace Hut Bridge, and then continue to Wallace Hut. Return to the Chalet

via the same route. There may be an option for an extended tour via the Pinnacles returning to the chalet via Cope Hut or the home slope.

General safety and considerations

All tours and journeys from Bogong Rover Chalet shall comply with procedures set out in Bogong Rover Chalet Operations Manual (1) and comply with relevant Alpine SS&P (5). Sections relevant to the inward and outward journeys include:

- i. Minimum party size of four (4).
- ii. Leaders are encouraged to mentor other participants on the journey.
- iii. Stronger skiers are encouraged to assist lesser and newer skiers to ensure that all participants arrive at the BRC safely and in good spirits
- iii. At least two members of the party shall have current first aid qualifications (HLTAID011 or equiv.).
- vi. The party can break into groups. The lead-skier of each group should set a pace such that the group does not get too strung out. In fine weather with light breeze and unlimited visibility, the party can stretch out more. In conditions of higher winds and poor or limited visibility the party should be more compressed, and line-of-sight maintained between lead-skier and tail-end-Charlie.
- x. If an injury occurs during the journey that leaves the casualty immobilised, the group leader shall seek direct assistance from the relevant emergency service and inform the Party Leader or nominee at the BRC as to the situation.
- xi. Two sets of medical forms are to be carried into the chalet. A set of medical forms should be carried on tours. A soft copy of medical forms is held on the PL phone.

Weather Considerations

If there are adverse weather conditions the activity may be modified or delayed at the discretion of the Party Leadership team (Nobs). The activity could be conducted within shelter in the Home valley within the sight of the Chalet or in another location. Experiencing poor weather while correctly prepared, clothed and supervised is a relevant skill for OAS and Adult Qualifications.

Trigger Points

Trigger points for cancelling the activity, or turning back early can include, but are not limited to deteriorating weather conditions, injuries or unsuitable snow conditions. These are at the discretion of the Tour leaders.

Leadership

The Leadership of this activity will be chosen from suitable participants. These may include the Nobs, but this is not necessary. The decision of the Nobs in the winter party is final and may override the activity leader.

Participants

All Winter Party Participants should participate in the Ski School tour. Roles of participants may vary based on their skills, qualifications and experience. Participants may include Rovers, Venturers and Leaders as well as non-movement members of all ages.

Participants are required to carry a day pack with essential safety gear and their share of food and group gear for the trip.

Basic Safety

White Board:

- All groups leaving the Chalet for any purpose should record their name on the white board in the dining room, and remove their name on return.

Counting:

- Group leaders should count all participants on snow prior to departure and regularly during the activity. Unaccounted party members should be located immediately.

Lead Skier/Navigator

- A lead skier for each group should be nominated and the group should not travel ahead of the lead.

Tail end Charlie / Whip

- A tail end Charlie / whip should be nominated and should remain at the back of the group for the tour. It's recommended that the tail end is an experienced skier and a first aider

Activity Plan

Saturday night. (suggested during the evening meal)

- Activity briefing
- Introduce activity leaders
- Outline equipment required

Sunday morning (prior to departure)

- Check equipment and clothing appropriate to current weather conditions
- Split into Groups

On Snow – Outside Ski Room

- Gear Check and Fitting Skis (left and right skis and leashes)
- Controlled fall and recovery (from stationary)
- Step turns and Kick turns
- Side step up slope to Syphon meeting point.

On Snow – Langfords west aqueduct – Flat/Slight downhill section

- Kick and Glide (Diagonal Stride)
- Double poling

- Skate (optional – conditions permitting)

On Snow – Wallace's turn off/Bridge

- Discussion about snow conditions and risk
 - Snow drifts
 - Snow Bridges over creeks
 - Cornices
 - Avalanches
- Introduce Uphill techniques
 - Herringbone
 - Uphill Diagonal Stride

On Snow – Wallace's Hut track

- Uphill techniques

On Snow – Adjacent to Wallace hut track – gentle downhill slopes

- Morning Tea – use sit mats, dig trenches for seats
- Controlled falls and recovery while moving
- Snowplough glide and brakes
- Single and linked snowplough turns

On Snow - Wallace's Hut

- Lunch
- Discussion
 - Huts code
 - Alpine Code
 - Emergency Shelter

At this point the Group may split.

- More competent skiers may return to chalet via pole line, and home slope or Cope Hut
- Less experienced skiers are encouraged to continue practicing downhill techniques before returning to the chalet via Wallace's Hut Track and Langford's West Aqueduct (Same route as out)
- Make sure there is enough skill left to assist the less experienced group back to the Chalet

During Activity

- Group should muster regularly to check on welfare, and ensure all members are present
- Hotspots should be managed to avoid developing into blister

On completion of Activity

- Participants will remove their name from the whiteboard
- Group equipment returned to its storage location

Group will hold a debrief/review of activity

Activity Map



Core Activity: There and back via same route

Optional Routes to return to Chalet:

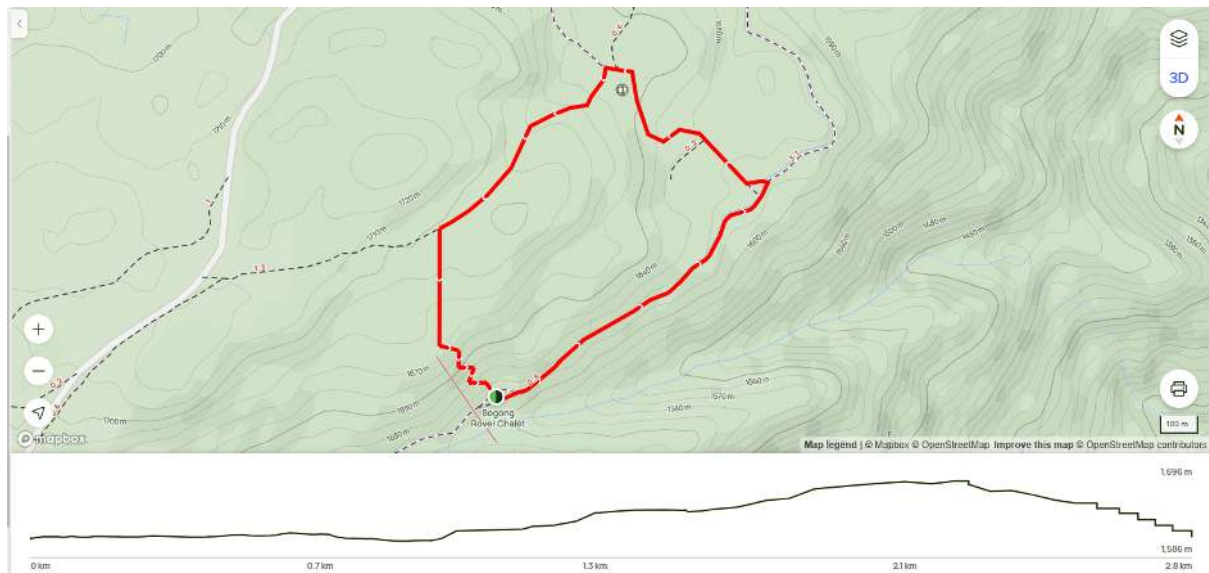
3 Hut Tour

Some parts are exposed – clear weather only – confident skiers in all skills



Return Via Home Slope

Possible in poor weather - very competent in downhill techniques



Considerations specific to the journey

As this is a compulsory first activity, the journey presents challenges that may not be present for other activities

- High likelihood of falls as new skills are being coached
- Unknown fitness and abilities of participants
- Unknown/untested gear
- A poor experience on the ski in prior
- The possibility of blisters, body aches and fatigue from the previous days activity.

These additional risks can manifest as:

- A reluctance to leave the chalet
- Slow party leading to increased fatigue and exposure of all present
- Inability or unwillingness of participants to continue
- Inability for participant to be self-sufficient on journey
- Increased risk of hypothermia and dangers of being cold/wet
- Increased sun exposure

These risks can be managed by:

- Participants encouraged to wear full waterproof gear – jacket, over pants and gloves.
- Activity Leader seek out less experienced participants prior to journey to discuss any issues and confidence levels prior to skiing.
- Positive encouragement as the activity is easier without a heavy pack
- Ensure participant has adequate gear, not excessive pack weight
- While the training components will be covered with the entire group, the party should be split in small groups of 4-8 with at least one experienced/competent skier for the transits between training locations.
- Appoint one or more strong/competent participants to accompany the slower participants.
- Appoint a whip as the absolute last participant of the journey.

- Ensure all groups are sure of the route to BRC
- If weather is bad, ensure that all participants are prepared for conditions prior to departing.
- Redistribute pack loads to ease burden on slower participants and to help manage blisters
- Encourage those affected to stop and manage blisters and sore spots early before it is too late.
- Manage fatigue with sufficient food, water and rest stops.
- Enact contingency plan if weather is unsafe for any/all participants to travel
- Return to Chalet or shelter at Wallace's Hut if safer than continuing activity.
- When considering the inbound and outbound journeys, the PL/PA must consider forecast weather conditions, snow conditions, party size and ability and monitor how conditions and the condition of party members tracks throughout the journey. While the inbound/outbound routes and timings are not amendable to much change, discretion should be exercised to ensure that the party is not subject to dangerous and life threatening conditions – dynamic risk management.
- All journeys to/from the BRC carry the usual risks of injury and equipment failure associated with skiing. These are addressed in the Emergency Management section below and in the associated Risk Assessment document, also referenced below.

Risk Management

See separate "Risk assessment – inbound_outbound.xlsx"

The alpine environment presents a number of hazards. The selection of the route for the activity avoids common potential snow hazards such as steep slopes, snow bridges, avalanche zones, etc. However, the usual alpine weather factors still persist including blizzards, poor visibility, hyperthermia, bright sunlight, sun exposure, altitude. In addition, even gentle slopes can present a hazard for novice skiers carrying a full pack.

Personal support

- Redistribute load
- Provide food and water
- Provide sunscreen and eye protection from other participants if inadequate
- Reduce day pack weight of less experienced participants to personal safety equipment only to help the participant manage speed and prevent injury

Group support

- Consider splitting party into small groups in transits between teaching locations to allow personalised coaching and allow participants to complete the journey at their own speed.
- Help participants to address blisters
- If trip is taken during poor weather, additional measures should be taken including:
 - Keep group together in sight
 - Actively check participant energy levels and hypothermia

- Consider use of Wallace's Hut as a warm up stop or to wait out the worst of the weather.
- In extreme cases, return to Chalet and reschedule as necessary.
- Request assistance if a participant is unable to continue to destination (e.g. injury, hypothermia).

Trip Intentions Form

In addition to this document, the BRC Trip Intentions Form needs to be completed and approved by Part Leader. The completed Trip Intentions Form forms part of the risk and activity plan.

The Trip Intentions Form will include:

- Activity Leader
- Designated First Aider
- Designated Tail End Charlie / Whip (should also be a qualified first aider).

Equipment List

Personal Clothing (worn or carried in daypack)

- Waterproof Jacket
- Waterproof Overpants
- Hat or Beanie
- Gloves
- Sunglasses / Goggles

Personal Equipment (Carried in daypack)

- Water (at least 1lt)
- Scroggin
- Lunch (or share of group lunch)
- Personal First Aid Kit (see packing guide)
- Sunscreen
- Torch
- Whistle
- Sit Mat
- Spare Warm Jumper
- Wet weather gear (if not wearing it)
- White-out cord
- Mobile Phone (with chalet and activity leaders / Nobs number saved)
- Map & Compass
- GPS (optional)

Group Equipment

- Touring First aid Kit
- Snow shovels
- Ski Repair Kit
- Bothy Bag / Tarp

- Sleeping Bag and Mat
- UHF Radio
- PLB (optional)

This is the minimum requirement – other items listed on the intentions form may be added at the group's discretion.

Training Outcomes

The intention of this activity is to provide demonstrations coaching and verification of skills for OAS or Adult Qualifications. Some of the information and knowledge required is covered during Winter Party Briefing Nights, Participant Information packs and resources at the Chalet.

Likely OAS outcomes:

- Alpine Stage 1
-

Likely Adult Training (Trained Participant-Alpine – Cross Country)

- What to take and wear on a X-C Ski Tour
- Hazard identification and recognition
- How snow conditions effect skiing
- Understand methods of communication within groups
- Skiing Skills:
 - Adhere to safe skiing practices
 - Demonstrate edging, ascending and descending and traversing mild slopes
 - Apply good rhythm, pace and body position on the flat
 - Demonstrate controlled falling and recovering
 - Execute single turns through the fall line
 - Complete climbs taking into account terrain, weather, party and snow conditions
 - Turn up in appropriate clothing and equipment for the days conditions
 - Demonstrate adequate navigation skills to traverse easy X-C terrain
 - Skills Requirements:
 - Stance
 - Controlled fall and recover
 - Walking and pushing with poles
 - Striding with glide and push (Diagonal Stride)
 - Uphill Diagonal Stride
 - Herringbone (Uphill)
 - Side stepping
 - Double poling
 - Snowplough Glide and Brake
 - Step Turn
 - Kick Turn
 - Snowplough Turn

- Linked Snowplough Turn
- Traverse down hill
- Downhill Run

During the course of the Winter Party, participants should be encouraged to participate in the following to cover the skills not covered in this activity.

- Complete 2 Cross Country Ski Tours
- Build an emergency shelter
- Have a discussion on different skiing gear and types
- Investigate ski trail and ski tour grading systems
- Investigate the Alpine Responsibility code

All participants are encouraged to complete the Trained Participant Workbook, This will assist in verification of skills for Adult Qualifications and as a way of verification for OAS.

Participants should get photos of participating in activities to verify personal log books and should also take a copy of the trip intentions as evidence for OAS or Adult Quals

Emergency management

If a participant requires immediate medical attention, call 000.

If a participant requires evacuation, but it is not urgent, call the police or SES at Falls Creek to discuss possible arrangements.

Request assistance from the chalet if the emergency can be managed with additional people and/or equipment.

Contact the Chalet if there is any emergency.

Consider whether to manage an injured or incapacitated person without moving, move to a nearby hut, or continue/return to the Chalet.

Rescue equipment available at the Chalet includes Akja rescue sled, snowshoes, roll up stretcher, blankets, sleeping bag, tarpaulin

If emergency services are called, or a person requires immediate medical treatment, you must contact the Scouts Victoria Emergency Line 03 8543 9877. A Scouts Victoria incident report will need to be submitted within 48 hours of the end of the trip. Keep notes to assist with preparing this incident report. The chalet warden Matt Anderson [REDACTED] must also be notified.

Emergency numbers

FOR ALL EMERGENCIES CALL 000

Bogong Rover Chalet [REDACTED]

Bogong Rover Chalet Warden Matt Anderson [REDACTED]

Scouts Victoria Emergency Line 03 8543 9877

Scouts Victoria State Leader Alpine, Peter Robinson [REDACTED]

Search & Rescue 03 5758 3213

Falls Creek Medical Centre 03 5758 3238

Mount Beauty Medical Centre 03 5758 3400
Falls Creek Police Station 03 5758 3424
SES at Windy Corner 03 5758 3432 or 13 25 00